Mac

Ableton Link over Ethernet. Do these in order.

Plug in

- ☐ Plug the adapter into the laptop and the cable into the switch.
- ☐ Wait one minute.
- ☐ System Settings > Network: the adapter shows Self-Assigned IP and an address starting 169.254. That is correct here.

Local Network permission (macOS 15 and later)

- ☐ System Settings > Privacy & Security > Local Network.
- ☐ Turn on Ableton Live.
- ☐ Quit Live and open it again.

Firewall

- ☐ System Settings > Network > Firewall. If it is off, skip this part.
- ☐ Click Options.
- ☐ Turn off Block all incoming connections.
- ☐ Find Ableton Live in the list and set it to Allow incoming connections. If it is missing, click + and add it from Applications.

In Live

- ☐ Open Settings (Cmd + ,) and choose Link, Tempo & MIDI.
- ☐ Set Show Link Toggle to Show.
- ☐ Click Link at the top left of the Live window.
- ☐ The button shows how many other laptops it sees. It should match the room.

Still no count

- Turn Wi-Fi off, wait ten seconds, look at the Link count again.
- Try a different port on the switch and a different cable.
- Unplug the adapter and plug it back in.

Windows

Ableton Link over Ethernet. Do these in order.

Plug in

- [ ] Plug the adapter into the laptop and the cable into the switch.
- [ ] Wait one minute.
- [ ] Settings > Network & internet > Ethernet shows Unidentified network, Public, no internet. That is correct here.

Firewall

- [ ] Start > type Allow an app through Windows Firewall > open it.
- [ ] Click Change settings.
- [ ] Find Ableton Live. Tick both Private and Public. Click OK.
- [ ] If it is missing: Allow another app > Browse > C:\ProgramData\Ableton\Live 12 ...\Program > pick the Ableton Live .exe > Add, then tick Private and Public.
- [ ] If Windows asks whether to allow Ableton Live when you turn Link on, tick both boxes and click Allow.

Other security software

- [ ] Norton, McAfee, Avast and similar run their own firewall. Allow Ableton Live there, or pause that firewall for the class.

In Live

- [ ] Open Settings (Ctrl + ,) and choose Link, Tempo & MIDI.
- [ ] Set Show Link Toggle to Show.
- [ ] Click Link at the top left of the Live window.
- [ ] The button shows how many other laptops it sees. It should match the room.

Still no count

- Turn Wi-Fi off, wait ten seconds, look at the Link count again.
- Try a different port on the switch and a different cable.
- If the adapter does not show up under Ethernet, it needs a driver. Borrow a different adapter.